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Project “Sugar Trap”: Market Gap Analysis

Identifying Blue Ocean Opportunities for the Healthy
Snacking Line

Prepared for Helix CG Partners





The “Sugar Trap” Challenge

Current global snack markets are oversaturated with high-sugar, low-protein products. Helix CPG aims to find the "Blue Ocean", which is a specific category where consumer demand for health (High Protein) is currently under-served.

Key Finding: Savory Snacks represent the largest untapped opportunity for R&D.





Data Integrity & Methodology

Source: Open Food Facts (Wolrd Database)

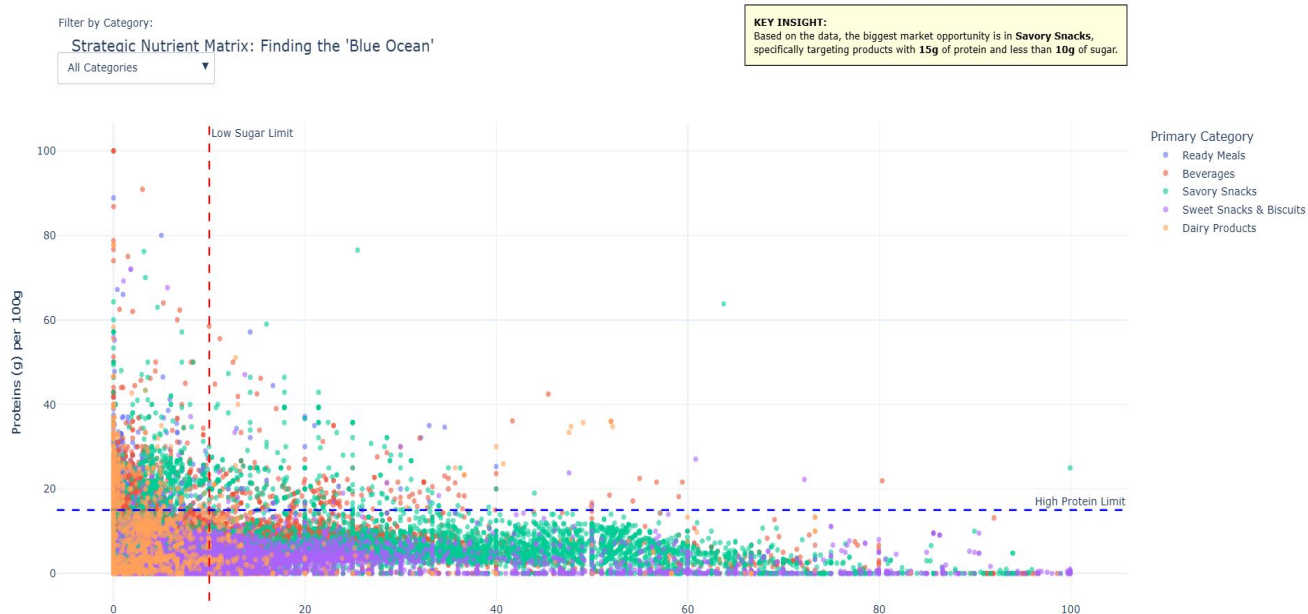
Scale: Analyzed 500,000+ raw entries

Cleaning: Removed 396k erroneous entries (missing nutrients or biologically impossible values).



The Strategic Nutrient Matrix

The Visual Evidence the Market Gap shows that there is a clear lack of high-protein competitors in the low-sugar zone.





The “Candidate’s Choice Metric”

Key Analysis:

- Dairy: Highest density (9.34 Ratio) but already crowded.
- Savory Snacks: 1.57 Ratio—the most viable transition for a snack manufacturer.
- Sweet Snacks: Failing at 0.63—avoid this category for a "Healthy" launch.

--- STORY 6: CANDIDATE'S CHOICE ---

Average Protein Efficiency (Higher = Better Blue Ocean Potential):

	Primary Category	Efficiency_Ratio
0	Dairy Products	9.340614
1	Ready Meals	5.474873
2	Beverages	2.364610
3	Savory Snacks	1.578158
4	Sweet Snacks & Biscuits	0.639659



The "Hidden Gem"

Analyzing the high-protein cluster reveals three primary drivers of success:

- 01 | Milk-based proteins (1,786 products)
- 02 | Soy-based proteins (945 products)
- 03 | Peanut-based proteins (512 products)

Recommendation: Utilize these specific protein sources to maximize the Efficiency Ratio in the new line.





Proposed Product Roadmap

Key Action: Launch a High-Protein Savory Snack

Protein

> 15g

The new product formulation should prioritize a high-density profile, delivering more than 15g of protein per 100g serving to meet consumer demand for functional nutrition.

Sugar

< 10g

To successfully exit the 'Sugar Trap,' the R&D team must strictly limit sugar content to less than 10g per 100g, ensuring the product qualifies as a low-sugar alternative.

Efficiency Target

> 1.5

We are setting a strategic Protein Efficiency Target of 1.5 or higher, ensuring our nutritional ROI significantly outperforms the current sweet-snack market average of 0.63.



Conclusion

Dominating the Healthy Snacking Aisle

Our analysis confirms that the path to market leadership for Helix CPG lies in a radical departure from traditional snack formulations. By aggressively moving away from sugar-heavy profiles and pivoting toward high-efficiency protein sources, the firm is positioned to capture the growing segment of health-conscious consumers currently ignored by major competitors.





Conclusion

Key-takeaway

By targeting the Savory Snack gap with a Protein Efficiency Ratio > 1.5, Helix CPG can effectively bridge the gap between 'indulgent snacking' and 'functional nutrition,' securing a first-mover advantage in this underserved market.

Next Step: Formulate Prototypes for Savory High-Protein Line.





Thank you.

